The Alpine Memories

Aurelia: When the cold wind rises, the mist clears from the northern peaks. I still remember the high stone steps of Tower I, the great brass dome turning in absolute silence, and the long winter nights we spent reading the stars together beside the fire.



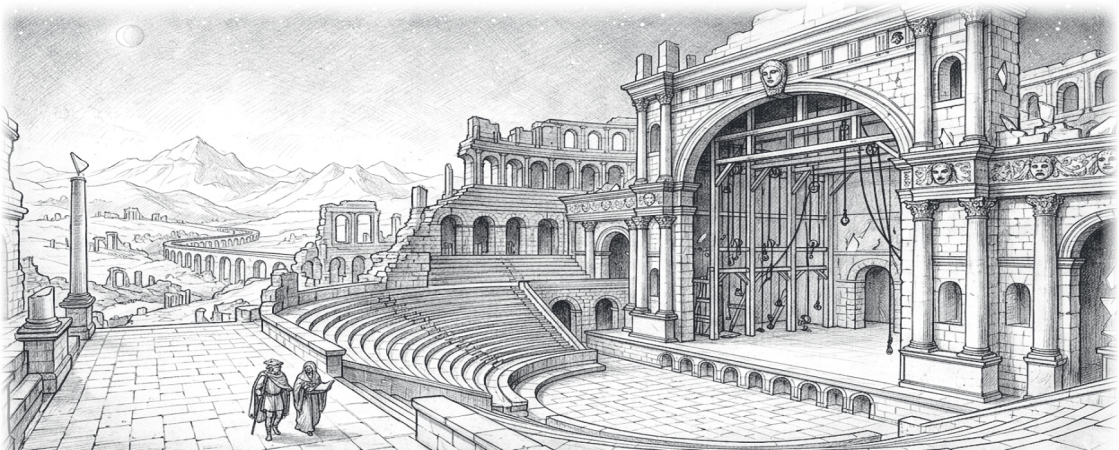
Tower I: The Alpine Observatory. The telescope slit faced Polaris through the longest winter nights.



Leontopodium nivale
High crags · alt. 2400 varas

Aurelia: This little white flower blooms in the deep rock fissures near the summit. Its petals are as soft as wool, shielding the tiny seed from the alpine frost. We pressed one into the pages of our Astrolabe log on the twenty-third day of September. If you climb high enough, the snow remembers every single footstep.

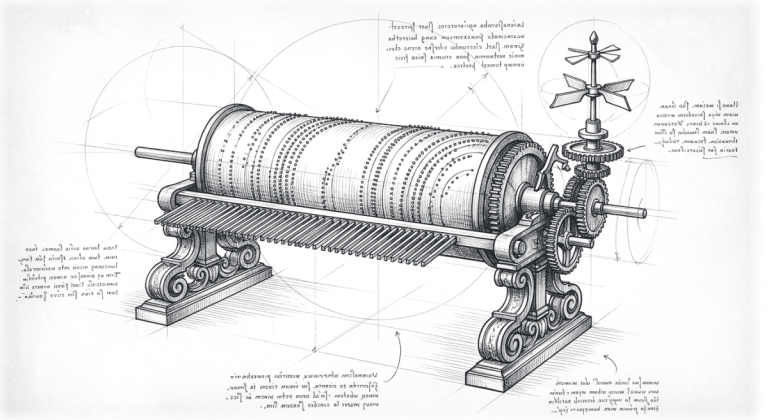
Hermes: She is beginning to remember the way back. The road to the peaks is still open.



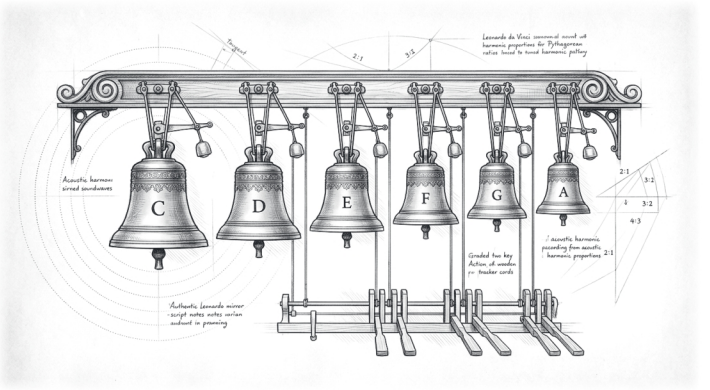
The Automaton Orchestra

In the silent music chamber of Tower III, three clockwork musicians sit motionless upon the stage. Carved from aged pearwood and polished brass, their hands rest frozen over lute, pipe, and dulcimer, waiting for the gears to turn once more. Beneath the cedar floorboards, a great bronze cylinder bristling with iron pins holds their forgotten melodies.

Study the measures upon the drum. The song that opens the gate is the reflection of the melody: read each pitch from the opposite rim of the cylinder, from the last measure to the first.



Six bronze bells hang beneath the soundboard, tuned to the natural hexachord. To open the door of the Orchestra, play the reflection of the melody upon the bells.



The tuning of the six bells: C · D · E · F · G · A. The last note struck is the first to unlock.